News

- Introduction

Posted by Hasan Shodiev

Edited

Tutorial Component

The tutorial component is held every week and is designed to support students in developing strong conceptual understanding, critical thinking, and problem-solving skills in physics.

Tutorials provide a structured and supportive environment in which students actively engage with physics problems related to the course material. Each session focuses on reasoning, application, and analysis, rather than passive review.

During tutorials, we work through carefully selected problems together. Students receive real-time guidance and feedback, encouraging them to:

- Think critically about physical situations in a variety of contexts
- Apply physics concepts with increasing confidence
- Refine the accuracy, clarity, and coherence of the reasoning

This iterative, hands-on problem-solving process strengthens conceptual foundations and cultivates a methodical scientific mindset—skills essential for success in both academic studies and professional scientific or technical fields.

PC141 Tutorial Schedule — First class

Tutorial Section	Month	Day	Time
PC141–T01	January 9	Friday	9:30 am – 10:20 am

Tutorial Section	Month	Day	Time
PC141 -T02	January 9	Friday	10:30 am – 11:20 am

(Please attend only the tutorial section for which you are registered.)

Preparation and Materials

To ensure productive and focused tutorial sessions, students are expected to come prepared. Please bring the following to every tutorial, starting with the first one:

- Your physics textbook and/or lecture notes
- A scientific calculator
- A notebook for handwritten problem solving and short quizzes

---

Digital Tools Policy

In alignment with the laboratory philosophy and to promote independent reasoning and authentic learning, digital devices are not permitted during tutorial sessions.

This includes cell phones, laptops, tablets, and smart devices, which must be turned off for the entire tutorial.

Tutorials are intentionally designed as spaces for focused thinking, manual problem solving, and direct engagement with physics concepts, particularly important in the era of powerful digital and AI-based tools.

Communication

Please do not send messages through MyLearningSpace.

You can reach me at hshodiev@wlu.ca using your myLaurier webmail account only.

When emailing, include your course code and tutorial section in the subject line (e.g., *PC141 – Tutorial Section T02*).

Emails without proper course and section identification may not receive a response.

I look forward to meeting you in the tutorials and working with you throughout the term.

- Tutorial Policies and Procedures

Posted by Hasan Shodiev

Edited

The policies governing the tutorial portion of this course are the same as those for the laboratory portion, unless otherwise stated below. This alignment ensures consistency in expectations, academic integrity, and professional conduct across all instructional formats.

Where necessary, additional policies specific to the tutorial format are outlined in this section.

Office Hours

Office Hours:
Room R2089
Thursdays, 4:00 pm – 6:00 pm

Tutorial Format

Tutorials are held every week and are designed as active problem-solving sessions.

The general tutorial format is as follows:

Open-Book Written Tutorial Report

- Tutorials typically involve the completion of a written, in-class tutorial report
- The report must reflect your own independent reasoning and work

Permitted Resources

Only the following resources are allowed during the tutorial:

- Scientific calculator
- Course textbook, if printed
- Lecture notes

- Homework and tutorial notes

Use of any other resources (including unauthorized digital tools, online resources, or AI-based systems) will result in a grade of zero for that week's tutorial report, and may lead to more severe academic penalties.

Instructional Support During Tutorials

- Instructional Assistants (IAs) are available during tutorials to answer general questions and provide guidance.
- IAs will not provide complete solutions, but will help clarify concepts, methods, and common pitfalls.
- Occasionally, tutorials may explore applications or examples beyond those covered in lecture, to deepen understanding and broaden perspective.

Preparation Expectations

To be successful in tutorials, students are expected to follow this preparation sequence each week:

10. Attend all lectures
11. Review lecture material and attempt assigned problems
12. Seek help early if needed:
    - Attend office hours
    - Consult your classmates
13. Carefully review feedback from previous tutorials and labs

Take note of mistakes and ensure they are not repeated

Consistent preparation is essential for meaningful participation and steady progress.

Attendance and Grading Policies

14. Attendance at the tutorial section in which you are registered is compulsory.

15. If you must miss a tutorial, email me once before the session when possible; all follow-up will be handled in person during your next lab/tut. Illness-based make-ups require a doctor's or walk-in clinic note; varsity travel needs an official athletics confirmation; other reasons require appropriate documentation. Make-ups are arranged within one week given section capacity and safety constraints.
Please do not send sensitive medical details—bring documentation to the lab/tut.

16. Tutorial grades will be posted on MyLearningSpace (MyLS).

17. The final tutorial grade will be determined out of 100%, based on the weighting specified in the course outline.

18. Any concerns regarding marking or grade recording must be raised within one week of the work being marked.

    - Contact your section IA first before contacting me.
    - No grade changes will be made after this period

Academic Integrity in Tutorials

Students are encouraged to actively engage in discussion and problem-solving during tutorial sessions. Collaboration in understanding concepts is welcomed.

However:

- All submitted tutorial reports must represent your own independent work
- Copying, reproducing, or transcribing another student's work—either in whole or in part—constitutes academic dishonesty
- Any form of cheating will be handled in accordance with the University's Academic Integrity Policy and may result in disciplinary action

Maintaining academic honesty is essential to the learning process and to the integrity of the course.